

Nebuchadrezzar joined battle with him, conquered him, and reduced the land at once to his dominion. It so happened at this time that his father fell ill in the city of Babylon and died, having reigned twenty-one years. When Nebuchadrezzar heard, not long afterward, of his father's end, he set in order the affairs of Egypt and the rest of the district, and committed the captives which he had taken from the Jews, Phœnicians, and Syrians, and from the nations belonging to Egypt, to some of his friends, that they might conduct the heavy-armed troops and the baggage to Babylonia, while he himself pushed over the desert with but a few to Babylon. When he arrived there he found that public affairs had been managed by the Chaldeans and the kingdom preserved by the principal persons among them, so that he was now ruler of all his father's dominions, and ordered the captives, when they arrived, to be assigned dwelling places in the most convenient parts of Babylonia.

τ' ἐκράτει καὶ τὴν χώραν ἐξ ἀρχῆς ὑπὸ τὴν αὐτῶν βασιλείαν ἐποιήσατο· τῷ τε πατρὶ αὐτοῦ συνέβη Ναβοπολασάρῳ κατὰ τοῦτον τον καιρὸν ἀρρωστήσαντι ἐν τῇ Βαβυλωνίῳ πόλει μεταλλάξαι τον βίον ἐτη βεβασιλευκότι· κά' αἰσθόμενος δὲ μετ' οὐ πολὺ τὴν τοῦ πατρὸς τελευτὴν Ναβουκοδρόσορος, καταστήσας τὰ κατὰ τὴν Αἴγυπτον πράγματα καὶ τὴν λοιπὴν χώραν, καὶ τοὺς αἰχμαλώτους Ἰουδαίων τε καὶ Φοινίκων καὶ Σύρων καὶ τῶν κατὰ τὴν Αἴγυπτον ἐθνῶν συντάξας τισὶ τῶν φίλων μετὰ τῆς βαρυντάτης δυνάμεως καὶ τῆς λοιπῆς ὠφελείας ἀνακομίζειν εἰς τὴν Βαβυλωνίαν, αὐτὸς ὁρμῆας ὀλιγοστὸς παρεγένετο διὰ τῆς ἐρήμου εἰς Βαβυλῶνα· καταλαβὼν δὲ τὰ πράγματα διοικούμενα ὑπὸ Χαλδαίων καὶ διατηρουμένην τὴν βασιλείαν ὑπὸ τοῦ βελτίστου αὐτῶν, κυριεύσας ὁλοκλήρου τῆς πατρικῆς ἀρχῆς τοῖς μὲν αἰχμαλώτοις παραγενομένοις συνέταξεν [αὐτοῖς] κατοικίας ἐν τοῖς ἐπιτηδαιοτάτοις τῆς Βαβυλωνίας τόποις ἀποδεῖξαι.

XI. NABONIDUS, BELSHAZZAR, AND CYRUS

Immediately upon the death of Nebuchadrezzar his son, Amel-Marduk,¹ the Evil-Merodach of the biblical

¹ Man (servant) of Marduk.